

CUA1

Culture

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A teacher with fifteen years of experience in a large suburban district says a newly enrolled student adopted by a family in another country will “naturally” share the customs of her birth country. The student arrived as an infant and has lived only with her adoptive family. Which statement best reflects how culture works?

- A. The student will share her birth country’s customs because culture is inherited.
- B. The teacher’s long experience makes the prediction reliable.
- C. The student has learned the culture of the family and community she grew up in; birthplace does not transmit culture.
- D. The student has no culture because she was adopted.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A school hosts a well-attended international night with food and costumes each spring. Meanwhile, some families say they feel unwelcome at conferences where teachers expect parents to challenge grades directly. Which level of culture explains the conference problem?

- A. Surface culture: food and dress differences.
- B. Neither; conferences are culture-free.
- C. Biological differences in temperament.
- D. Deep culture: norms about authority and how to talk to teachers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

On a field trip to a museum with a new cultural exhibit, a student notices that in the culture displayed, people eat meals with their hands. The student says, “That’s gross and wrong.” The exhibit had a large audio guide. Which response best models cultural relativism?

- A. Tell the student every practice in every culture is beyond question.
- B. Ask the student what customs and meanings might surround eating with hands in that culture, and how our own table manners might look to others.
- C. Suggest the student listen to more of the audio guide.
- D. Agree that forks are the correct way to eat.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A visitor from another country says a local custom of eating dinner at 5 p.m. is “uncivilized” because in her country dinner is at 9 p.m. What is she showing?

- A.** Cultural relativism.
- B.** Cultural universal.
- C.** Ethnocentrism.
- D.** Acculturation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A young child in a busy, multigenerational household learns from grandparents which greetings show respect, what foods are served on holidays, and how to address elders. The family lives near a large public library. What process is this?

- A.** Enculturation.
- B.** Acculturation.
- C.** Formal education, since culture is only learned in school.
- D.** Assimilation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

After two years in a new country, an adult immigrant starts using some local slang and adopts a new breakfast routine. Which process does this change show?

- A.** Acculturation.
- B.** Enculturation.
- C.** Assimilation, because any change means the heritage culture is lost.
- D.** Ethnocentrism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A family that moved to a new country three years ago speaks their heritage language at home, celebrates their traditional holidays, and also joins the school's parent group and local sports leagues. The parents both work in health care. Which acculturation strategy describes them?

- A. Marginalization.
- B. Separation.
- C. Integration.
- D. Assimilation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student stops speaking his heritage language, refuses family traditions, and adopts only the customs of his new country. Which strategy is this?

- A. Enculturation.
- B. Separation.
- C. Integration.
- D. Assimilation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A student whose parents come from two different countries, who is a devout member of her faith community, and who was raised in a rural town, is placed on a school committee as “the voice of” her parents’ ethnic group. She is also on the honor roll. What concern does this raise?

- A. Her grades make her the best spokesperson.
- B. She should represent the rural town instead.
- C. None; ethnicity always defines a person’s views.
- D. It reduces her to one label; her identity includes several overlapping groups whose importance varies by context.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A teacher who recently read a popular book on intercultural communication learns that people from one region often avoid direct disagreement. She has a new student from that region, a strong writer. Which approach uses the information correctly?

- A. Ignore all group information, since any pattern is a stereotype.
- B. Offer several ways to share disagreement, such as written feedback, and watch how this student actually prefers to communicate.
- C. Have the student write more because she is a strong writer.
- D. Assume the student will never disagree and stop asking for opinions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement is a stereotype rather than a generalization?

- A. "Surveys suggest many families in that community value punctuality; I'll check with each family."
- B. "Students from that community are all quiet in class."
- C. "Any statement about a group is a stereotype."
- D. "Our school has families from twelve language groups."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

During a project in a newly remodeled classroom, a student repeatedly asks that credit go to the whole team and is uncomfortable being singled out for praise. The class is 28 students. How might a teacher best interpret this?

- A. It may reflect a collectivist orientation that values group harmony, so group recognition may motivate better than public individual praise.
- B. A class of 28 is too large to praise individuals.
- C. The student is hiding that others did the work.
- D. The student lacks confidence and needs more individual praise.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A teacher ~~with fifteen years of experience in a large suburban district~~ says a newly enrolled student adopted by a family in another country will “naturally” share the customs of her birth country. The student arrived as an infant and has lived only with her adoptive family. Which statement best reflects how culture works?

Target word: how culture is acquired **Decides:** Culture is learned from the groups one is raised in.

A	Inverted operation	Treats culture as biological.
B	Camouflage	Experience does not change how culture is acquired.
C	Correct	Culture is learned and shared, not inherited.
D	Absolute language	Everyone learns culture from the groups around them.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A school hosts a ~~well-attended~~ international night ~~with food and costumes each spring~~. Meanwhile, some families say they feel unwelcome at conferences where teachers expect parents to challenge grades directly. Which level of culture explains the conference problem?

Target word: which level of culture **Decides:** Norms about authority and communication are deep culture.

A	Camouflage	Answers the international-night detail, not the conference issue.
B	Absolute language	School routines carry cultural expectations.
C	Adjacent category	Behavior norms are learned, not biological.
D	Correct	Unspoken norms shape behavior at conferences.

3. Answer B Concept 3

On a field trip to a museum ~~with a new cultural exhibit~~, a student notices that in the culture displayed, people eat meals with their hands. The student says, “That’s gross and wrong.” ~~The exhibit had a large audio guide.~~ Which response best models cultural relativism?

Target word: response that models relativism **Decides:** Understand the practice within its own context.

A	Absolute language	Relativism seeks understanding; it does not forbid any ethical evaluation.
B	Correct	Seeks understanding in context rather than judgment.
C	Camouflage	Deflects to the exhibit detail without addressing the judgment.
D	Inverted operation	Endorses the ethnocentric judgment.

4. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

A visitor from another country says a local custom of eating dinner at 5 p.m. is “uncivilized” because in her country dinner is at 9 p.m. What is she showing?

Target word: name the stance **Decides:** Judging another culture by her own norm.

A	Inverted operation	Relativism would try to understand the custom in context.
B	Adjacent category	A universal is a trait shared by all cultures, not an attitude.
C	Correct	She uses her own culture as the standard.
D	Confusion set	Acculturation is change through contact, not judgment.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A young child in a busy, multigenerational household learns from grandparents which greetings show respect, what foods are served on holidays, and how to address elders. ~~The family lives near a large public library.~~ What process is this?

Target word: name the process **Decides:** Learning one's first, home culture.

A	Correct	Learning one's own culture from family and community.
B	Confusion set	Acculturation is change through contact with a different culture.
C	Absolute language	Most culture is learned informally.
D	Adjacent category	An acculturation outcome, not first-culture learning.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

After two years in a new country, an adult immigrant starts using some local slang and adopts a new breakfast routine. Which process does this change show?

Target word: name the process **Decides:** Change caused by sustained contact with a different culture.

A	Correct	Cultural change through continuing contact with another culture.
B	Inverted operation	Enculturation is learning one's first culture as a child.
C	Absolute language	Adopting some new habits does not mean giving up heritage culture.
D	Confusion set	Ethnocentrism is a judgment, not a process of change.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A family that moved to a new country three years ago speaks their heritage language at home, celebrates their traditional holidays, and also joins the school's parent group and local sports leagues. ~~The parents both work in health care.~~ Which acculturation strategy describes them?

Target word: which strategy **Decides:** Heritage kept and new culture joined.

A	Inverted operation	Marginalization loses both; this family keeps both.
B	Confusion set	Separation avoids the new culture.
C	Correct	Keeps heritage culture and takes part in the new one.
D	Confusion set	Assimilation gives up the heritage culture.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A student stops speaking his heritage language, refuses family traditions, and adopts only the customs of his new country. Which strategy is this?

Target word: which strategy **Decides:** Heritage given up, new culture adopted.

A	Adjacent category	Enculturation is first-culture learning, not an acculturation strategy.
B	Inverted operation	Separation keeps heritage and avoids the new culture.
C	Dropped element	Integration would keep the heritage culture too.
D	Correct	Gives up heritage culture for the new one.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A student whose parents come from two different countries, who is a devout member of her faith community, and who was raised in a rural town, is placed on a school committee as “the voice of” her parents’ ethnic group. ~~She is also on the honor roll.~~ What concern does this raise?

Target word: concern **Decides:** Identity is multiple; one label does not define her.

A	Camouflage	Grades do not address the identity issue.
B	Adjacent category	Swaps one single label for another.
C	Absolute language	No single group label predicts an individual’s views.
D	Correct	Cultural identity is multiple and fluid.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A teacher ~~who recently read a popular book on intercultural communication~~ learns that people from one region often avoid direct disagreement. She has a new student from that region, ~~a strong writer.~~ Which approach uses the information correctly?

Target word: correct use of group information **Decides:** A generalization is a hypothesis checked with the individual.

A	Inverted operation	Generalizations used flexibly can help understanding.
B	Correct	Treats the pattern as a hypothesis and tests it with the individual.
C	Camouflage	Answers the writing detail, not the use of cultural information.
D	Absolute language	Turns a tendency into a fixed rule: a stereotype.

11. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

Which statement is a stereotype rather than a generalization?

Target word: pick the stereotype **Decides:** A stereotype applies a fixed belief to every member.

A	Inverted operation	A tested generalization, the opposite of a stereotype.
B	Correct	Applies a fixed trait to every member with no room for the individual.
C	Absolute language	Flexible generalizations about tendencies are not stereotypes.
D	Adjacent category	A demographic fact, not a belief about traits.

12. Answer A Concept 8

During a project ~~in a newly remodeled classroom,~~ a student repeatedly asks that credit go to the whole team and is uncomfortable being singled out for praise. ~~The class is 28 students.~~ How might a teacher best interpret this?

Target word: interpretation **Decides:** Preference for group credit fits a collectivist orientation.

A	Correct	Connects the behavior to a cultural orientation without assuming it for every student.
B	Camouflage	Class size does not explain the preference.
C	Adjacent category	Reads a cultural preference as dishonesty.
D	Inverted operation	Applies an individualist lens to group-oriented behavior.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Culture is learned and shared	Culture is a shared system of beliefs, values, practices and meanings that people learn from their groups; it is not inherited biologically.	Treating culture as fixed by ancestry, race or birthplace.	An explanation of behavior based on “blood” or genes.
2	Surface vs. deep culture	Visible culture (food, dress, holidays) rests on deeper, less visible culture (values, norms about time, authority, family and communication), which shapes behavior most.	Addressing culture only through foods-and-festivals activities.	A misunderstanding about norms, not objects.
3	Ethnocentrism vs. cultural relativism	Ethnocentrism judges other cultures by one’s own standards; cultural relativism seeks to understand practices within their own context.	Calling a practice “wrong” or “rude” because it differs from one’s own norm.	A judgment made from the observer’s own norms.
4	Enculturation vs. acculturation	Enculturation is learning one’s first culture; acculturation is change that happens through sustained contact with another culture.	Using the terms interchangeably.	Whether the learning is of a home culture or from contact with a new one.
5	Acculturation strategies	In Berry’s model, integration keeps the heritage culture while taking part in the new one; assimilation gives up the heritage culture; separation keeps heritage and avoids the new; marginalization loses both.	Calling any adaptation “assimilation.”	Whether heritage culture is kept and whether the new culture is joined.
6	Cultural identity is multiple and fluid	Each person holds several overlapping group identities (ethnicity, language, religion, region, generation), whose importance shifts by context.	Assuming a single label predicts a person’s identity or values.	A person who belongs to more than one cultural group.
7	Generalization vs. stereotype	A generalization is a starting hypothesis about group tendencies that is tested against the individual; a stereotype is a fixed belief applied to every member.	Treating any mention of group patterns as a stereotype, or treating a pattern as true of every member.	“All” or “always” about a group vs. “often” checked with the person.
8	Individualist vs. collectivist orientation	Individualist cultures emphasize personal goals and independence; collectivist cultures emphasize group harmony, obligations and interdependence.	Reading group-oriented behavior as lack of initiative or dishonesty.	A preference for group credit, group work, or consulting family.

Course scope (public description): Focuses on the nature and role of culture and the importance of cultural groups and cultural identity.